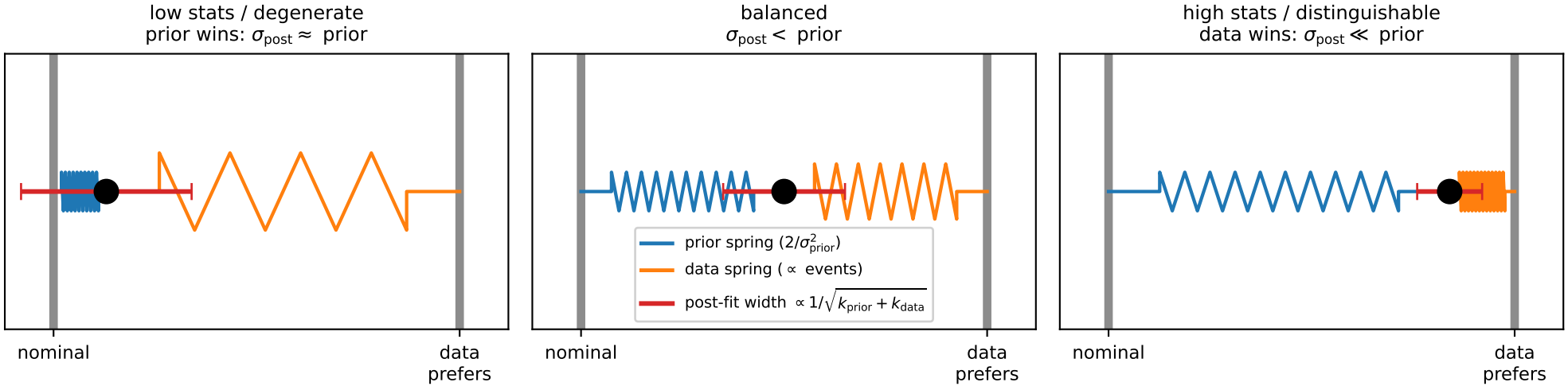A parameter is pinned by the balance of two springs (a template has no prior spring)